

# where the channel aims, priced

Five rings derived by named constraint relaxation, a 3-2-1 content mix with a chaos dart, a full sourcing map — who to study, and for what — and the layer the niche never ships: every bucket wired to the \$750/\$2,500 offer ladder with a dollar-defined kill-or-keep rule answerable by batch three.

|                                               |                                                                        |                                                                                              |                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <div>WINDOW</div> <div>engagement start</div> | <div>LENS</div> <div>audience architecture ·<br/>offer economics</div> | <div>SOURCES</div> <div>dossier + whitespace<br/>map + 12-channel<br/>competitive scan</div> | <div>COMPILED</div> <div>aug 28, 2026</div> |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|

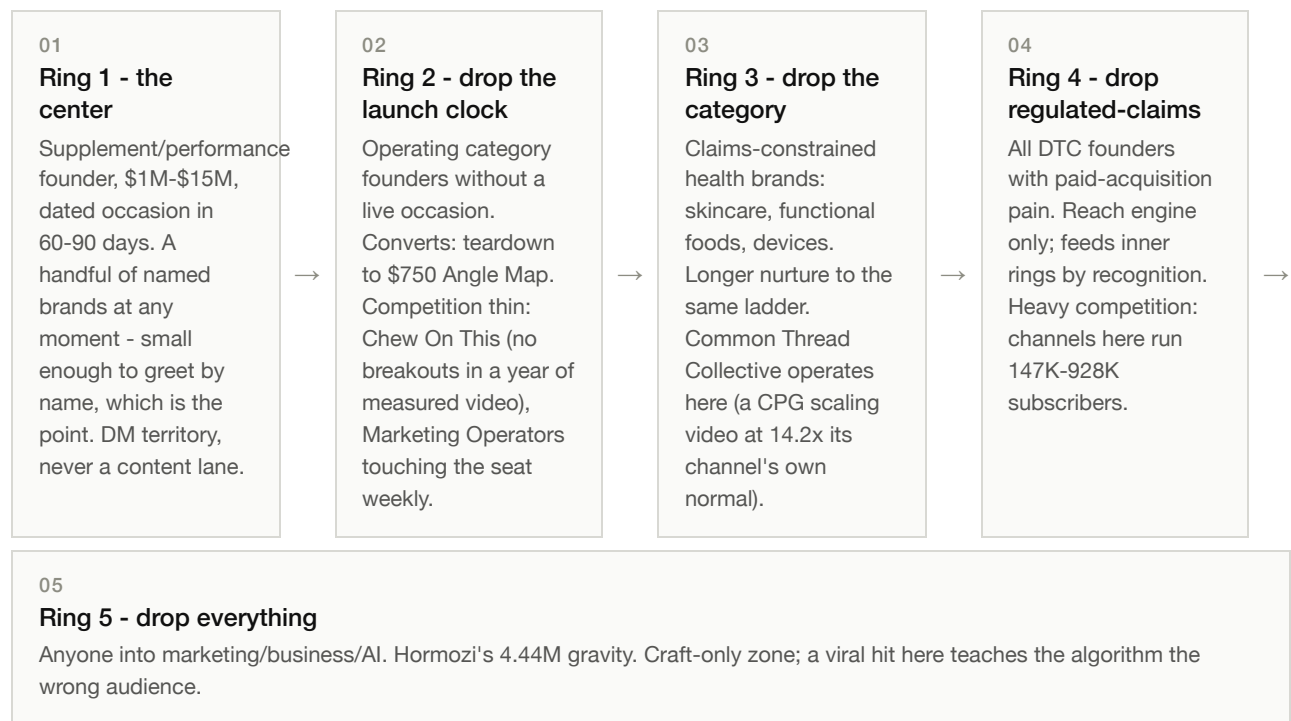
01

## define, hit, expand

THE AIM

The center is one person: the founder-formulator of an already-selling supplement or performance brand under \$15M with a dated launch occasion inside 60-90 days, who keeps buying mechanisms to avoid an unmade message decision. Each ring outward drops exactly one named filter - the launch clock, then the category, then the regulated-claims constraint, then everything. Rings are auditable decisions, not vibes: you can argue about which filter comes off first. The batch shape is 3-2-1: two narrow buckets at Ring 2 (trust and conversion), one broad at Ring 4 (reach, fenced), one chaos dart. Ring 5 gets a warning band, not a bucket.

## 02 the five rings



EACH STEP DROPS ONE NAMED CONSTRAINT

**The Defensible Claim (Ring 2, conversion) - the open claim-substantiation lane**

Feeds the Sprint via the Angle Map. Working = at least 2 DMs/comments per batch from operating founders mentioning claims, launch, or proof. Kill/keep: below 2 across batches 2-3, swap in Launch Math; at 4+, add a third slot. Lead value ~\$300 per qualified inquiry on the stated basis

**LIKELY**

basis: \$750 x 20% close + \$2,500 x 20% x 30% upgrade - held as assumptions until the first ten sends log outcomes

**The Counter Files (Ring 2, trust) - the proof register no incumbent can copy**

Five years behind the Vitamin Shoppe counter - the last person buyers questioned before they'd pay - plus eighteen years training 1,000+ clients: buyer-side proof no scale story can match. Working = at least 1 'this is exactly my buyer' reply per batch. Kill/keep: below 1 across 2-3 batches, swap in The Convert

**VERIFIED**

the whitespace map's buyer-side-proof finding: pool proof is seller-side scale; nobody stakes authority on having been the buyer's last checkpoint

**The Fix Aisle (Ring 4, reach) - honestly flagged reach-only**

Rides the niche's proven news-jack skeleton (64.2x ceiling receipt, mywifequitherjob) to install the decision-before-mechanism belief. \$0 direct lead value claimed. Working = one 3x+ breakout per two batches AND 30%+ of engagers identifiably Rings 2-4

**VERIFIED**

skeleton receipt: Amazon news-jack, 1.4M views, 64.2x the channel's own normal ↗

**Chaos dart, batch 1: ChatGPT built the same supplement brand ten times**

Demonstrates the sameness machine instead of describing it. A win teaches whether demonstration outperforms telling. Probes the open claim lane and the mis-fix critique at once; the reserve below holds four more candidates, each wild in a different way

**VERIFIED**

chaos reserve, pre-screened against the whitespace map

**The bench - five challengers, stocked and warm**

The Sameness Files (Ring 3, trust): nine supplement homepages, one voice - first challenger in on any swap · Launch Math (Ring 2, conversion): price the unmade decision in the buyer's own numbers - the \$30K lesson, the 140 ads - first swap for The Defensible Claim · The Data Mirage (Ring 3, trust): why your ROAS lies to you - enters if The Counter Files converts but plateaus on reach · AI Answer Shelf (Ring 3, conversion): why ChatGPT names your competitor - enters when a prospect's trigger is AI-search invisibility · The Convert (Ring 2, proof): the 2018-to-2026 conversion story - never a full bucket, recurs one slot in three batches

**VERIFIED**swap rules priced in the money map above; his own swap beats this ranking**The chaos reserve - four darts banked behind the first**

Read a real FTC warning letter on camera, line by line, then rewrite the claim so it survives · The 48-hour Angle Map performed as a four-minute timelapse on an anonymized brand · Naptime Strategy: the positioning practice that runs in 90-minute naps · 'Everyone copies Hormozi's volume advice - a regulated brand legally cannot.' One dart per batch; each wild in a different direction, so every throw teaches something the plan can use

**VERIFIED**each pre-screened against the whitespace map05 **the two-zone rule**

## SOURCING DOCTRINE

Topics stay on the ring the bucket sits on: The Defensible Claim and The Counter Files source Rings 1-3 - the buyer's own words are the deepest well - and The Fix Aisle sources Ring 4, then re-aims every piece at the operating supplement founder by name in line one. Craft - formats, hooks, storytelling, editing, pacing - comes from anywhere on the board, Ring 5 and other niches included: borrow the compression promise (14.1x), the news-jack timing (64.2x), the interview rhythm (15.9x). Ring 5 is craft-only; sourcing topics there is how a claim-safe strategist's channel drifts into being another marketing channel. And an empty ring is not a problem - it is your opening: pull from the adjacent ring and re-aim.

## Ring 1 - the center. Topic gold, never a lane

The pillar: the buyer's own words. This ring publishes nothing and supplies everything - the founders you serve are already saying the lines: creative fatigue in ten days, \$30K for 56 orders, compliant and still throttled. The Defensible Claim and The Counter Files pull their titles from here; the DM pipeline itself stays private. Make from it: 'Creative fatigue is killing my ads after 10 days' - the message problem wearing a media costume · The \$30K lesson: 56 orders and nothing learned · 'My ads are FDA compliant - so why am I throttled?'. Study: no true Ring-1 creator exists on the measured board - founders with a live launch clock don't run channels; the nearest stand-in is Chew On This (topic inspiration - Obvi's own founders, watched for what an operating founder worries about out loud, the week it happens). The trap: Ring 1 is a person you speak to, not a lane you publish in - keep pipeline brands out of public content; named critique stays in the private teardown. Quiet search shelf: supplement founder podcast · supplement launch diary

VERIFIED

[buyer verbatims: fifteen sourced quotes in the positioning dossier's pain bank](#)

## Ring 2 - operating founders, no launch clock. Topics for the narrow buckets

The pillar: claim substantiation as a growth decision. Zero of the 50 top-performing videos in this niche touch claims, compliance, or message defensibility - and the only supplement-specific channel teaches launch mechanics instead; the lane is open, and the incumbent is actively manufacturing the problem you fix. The Defensible Claim and The Counter Files live here; Launch Math waits on the bench. Make: The \$53,088 sentence - what one over-claim can cost at the FTC's per-violation penalty · The claim ladder: say only what your proof carries · The question every buyer asked me at the counter before they'd pay · Compliant and still throttled - the health-flag playbook. Study: Chew On This (topic inspiration - for how an operating founder talks about a launch, not for topics to copy) · Marketing Operators (topic inspiration - for what operating marketers argue about weekly; their ROAS distrust is the ground The Data Mirage stands on). The trap, printed here not buried: zero breakouts means no incumbent has cracked it - and no demand proof yet; both readings stay on the table until batch 3. Quiet search shelf: supplement brand FTC warning letter · supplement launch messaging · supplement founder marketing

VERIFIED

[topic scan of the full 50-video outlier pool, aug 2026](#)

## Ring 3 - claims-constrained health brands. Topics for the bench

The pillar: same handcuffs, different shelf. Skincare, functional foods, and wellness devices carry the exact claims constraint your buyer lives under, and the appetite for operating discipline is proven - a CPG scaling video ran 14.2x its channel's own normal in August; nobody connects that discipline to the claim decision. The bench sources here: The Sameness Files, The Data Mirage, AI Answer Shelf - stocked for the week a swap fires. Make: Nine supplement homepages, one voice · The white-label machine · Why your ROAS lies to you · Why ChatGPT names your competitor. Study: Common Thread Collective (topic inspiration - for how measurement-minded operators frame growth constraints; they will never say 'claims,' which is exactly the gap you fill). The trap: adjacency drift - a skincare topic that loses the claims thread becomes wellness content, and wellness content is Ring 4 with better lighting. Quiet search shelf: skincare claims marketing · functional food compliance · health brand positioning

**VERIFIED**[receipt: 'Do This to Scale Your CPG Brand', 9.9K views, 14.2x the channel's own normal, aug 2026 ↗](#)

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### Ring 4 - all DTC founders and operators. Topics for the broad bucket, re-aimed

The pillar: the mis-fix teardown. Every channel at this altitude sells a mechanism; nobody runs the named critique - and the wave pool is live, with the mechanism beat's top rows all inside the last 60 days: Meta's AI ad push, in-chat AI checkout, the Etsy squeeze. The Fix Aisle sources here, and only here. Make: Claude just took over Meta ads - the decision it still cannot make · The quiz-funnel fix: what it does, what it dodges · AI checkout just moved product discovery. Study: mywifequitherjob (topic inspiration - for which platform shift matters this week; their Amazon read ran 64x the channel's own normal - take the wave, never the generality) · Chase Chappell (topic inspiration - for the new-tool waves worth granting before you name what they can't decide, 21.8x) · Sabri Suby (craft only - the compression promise skeleton, never the everyone-audience). The re-aim rule, as a sentence: borrow the news-jack skeleton, then land it on the operating supplement founder by name in line one - broad in audience, never broad in address. The trap: two of the three winning platform-shift rows are one creator; that's a person winning, not a topic winning - source the shape, not the subject. Quiet search shelf: DTC creative fatigue · CAC rising ecommerce · ecommerce ad testing

**VERIFIED**[receipt: 'Claude Has Officially Changed Facebook Ads', 41K views, 21.8x the channel's own normal, aug 2026 ↗](#)

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### Ring 5 - the whole marketing internet. Craft only, never topics

The pillar: the craft shelf. Nothing at this altitude is a topic for this channel; everything at this altitude is technique - and the board's best technique lives here, measured. No bucket sources topics here; every bucket borrows craft from here. Take the skeletons: the compression promise - 'give me N minutes, I'll teach you X' (Sabri Suby, 14.1x) · news-jack timing - publish inside the platform-shift window (64.2x ceiling) · the interview cut - story first, tactics as seasoning (foundr, 15.9x). Study: Alex Hormozi (craft only - parasocial authority mechanics and retention pacing; his topics serve everyone, which is exactly why they can't serve you) · Davie Fogarty (craft only - proof-by-building energy on camera; his audience is aspirants, not operators) · foundr (craft only - the interview cut rhythm). The trap: craft permission is not topic permission - sourcing subjects here is the specific act that drifts a claim-safe strategist's channel into being another marketing channel, and drift starts as one 'broader' video

**VERIFIED**[receipt: Sabri Suby's compression-promise flagship, 201K views, 14.1x the channel's own normal, jul 2026 ↗](#)

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## CALIBRATION DISCIPLINE

# the rules printed on the tracker

Decisions in dollars and counts, never vibes.

### 01 No verdict on any video inside 24 hours

Early numbers lie; a video's first day says nothing about where it settles

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### 02 No bucket demotion before batches 2-3

Two to three batches is the minimum signal for a kill/keep call

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### 03 Count conversions in 'working =' units logged in his own inbox

He logs his own sends and DMs; every threshold above is observable without a dashboard

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### 04 Ring 5 stays craft-only

Topics from the bucket's own ring, craft from anywhere - sourcing topics from Ring 5 is how channels drift generic

## THE BASES

# what is assumed, said out loud

Close rates are assumptions (20% inquiry-to-Map, 30% Map-to-Sprint), held as pending until the first ten sends log outcomes. Ring sizes are read from the subscriber counts of the channels serving each ring, not from measured audiences; a keyword-volume pull would harden them. Trend-velocity readings from this scan window are too young to read; the next scheduled scan hardens them. The center's pipeline counts are his own logged facts.

09 **source ledger**

| #  | SOURCE                                                   | URL | RETRIEVED  | USED FOR                                                               | CONFIDENCE |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------|-----|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 01 | Positioning dossier + whitespace map (this engagement)   | —   | 2026-08-27 | center statement, bucket candidates, sourcing pillars, buyer verbatims | VERIFIED   |
| 02 | Competitive channel scan (12 channels, 50 ranked videos) | —   | 2026-08-27 | ring competition receipts, skeleton ceilings, who-to-study tags        | VERIFIED   |
| 03 | Offer ladder (list prices on record)                     | —   | 2026-08-27 | list prices \$750 / \$2,500                                            | VERIFIED   |